Week 7 Session 2 AI Innovation Showcase

Week 7, Session 2 — AI Innovation Showcase

IDSC 4101: Agentic AI for Business Applications

Session type: Trade show–style capstone presentations with external guests **Format:** Teams at stations; guests rotate; no formal class-wide presentations **Prerequisites:** Demo + 3-slide pitch deck submitted via LMS before session

---

INSTRUCTOR GUIDE

Note: This session has no lecture slides — it is a live showcase event. This document contains the full instructor setup guide, facilitation notes, timing, guest judge packet, and post-showcase debrief structure.

SECTION 1: SESSION OVERVIEW AND RATIONALE

Why a Trade Show Format?

The AI Innovation Showcase is deliberately designed as a professional environment rather than a classroom one. The trade show format — teams at stations, guests rotating — serves several pedagogical purposes that a round-robin class presentation does not:

1. Repetition builds fluency. Each team delivers their pitch 6–8 times to different guests. By the third or fourth delivery, students who were nervous and over-rehearsed have relaxed into a more natural explanation of their work. The repetition produces conversational fluency that a single polished presentation cannot.

2. Questions reveal understanding. Guest judges are briefed to ask open-ended, probing questions — not to evaluate by rubric, but to probe for genuine understanding. A student who memorized a presentation will struggle with "but what does it actually do?" A student who built the thing and understands it will not. The format rewards real learning.

3. Professional norms apply. The presence of external guests — practitioners, entrepreneurs, industry professionals — raises the stakes in a productive way. Students communicate differently when the audience includes people who make real decisions about AI. That code-switching (from classroom to professional register) is itself a learning outcome.

4. Every team member is accountable. In a class-wide presentation, one spokesperson can carry the team. At a station, guests ask anyone. Students who haven't engaged with the work are exposed — and students who have are recognized.

SECTION 2: SETUP AND LOGISTICS

Room Setup

Configuration: - One station per team, arranged around the perimeter of the room or in a grid with clear sightlines - Each station: one table, power access, team's laptop running demo, printed 3-slide pitch deck (optional but recommended as a leave-behind) - Station number assigned in advance and posted via LMS before the session

Guest arrival: - External guests arrive at session start or 5 minutes before - Instructor greets guests, distributes judge packets, gives 3-minute orientation (see Section 4) - Students are at their stations before guests enter — no milling around during guest arrival

Technology check: - Instructor confirms all demo laptops are working 10 minutes before session start - Any team with a non-working demo: fallback is a recorded screen capture of the demo (acceptable; note in grading) - n8n and Voiceflow are cloud-based — confirm internet access before the session

Timing

Phase	Duration	What happens
Instructor setup + student station check	10 min before session	All teams at stations, demos running, materials ready
Guest orientation	5 min	Instructor briefs guests on format and rubric
Showcase rounds	55 min	Guests rotate; each team has ~8 minutes per guest visit
Closing	5 min	Instructor thanks guests, releases them; students stay
Post-showcase debrief	20 min	Class-only: reflection, instructor observations, close

Guest rotation: With 5–6 teams and 4–6 guests, informal rotation works: guests move when they feel ready, guided by a visible timer on screen showing the current round. Alternatively, assign a rotation schedule in the judge packet if the guest group is large (10+).

SECTION 3: STUDENT PREPARATION CHECKLIST

Distribute via LMS before Session 2. Displayed on screen at session start while guests are being oriented.

Before the session: ☐ Demo submitted to LMS (working demo link + 3-slide pitch deck) ☐ Demo is running and tested on the laptop you'll use at your station ☐ Every team member can explain the demo — not just the spokesperson ☐ You know your responsible AI moment (the risk you identified + the design choice you made) ☐ You have thought about "if you had three more weeks" — guests will ask this

At your station: ☐ Laptop open, demo running or ready to run on one click ☐ 3-slide pitch deck printed or visible on a second screen (if available) ☐ Team introduction ready: "Hi, I'm [name], and this is [team name]. We built [one sentence]. Want to see it?"

Your 90-second pitch structure (deliver this to each guest before the live demo): 1. The problem: who has it, what it costs them — *specific and concrete* 2. The AI solution: what your system does — *behavioral, not abstract* 3. The responsible AI moment: one risk and one design choice — *named explicitly*

When a guest asks you something you don't know: Say "That's a great question — I don't know the answer, but here's how I'd find out." Never fabricate. Guests are briefed to respect honest uncertainty.

SECTION 4: GUEST JUDGE PACKET

Print one copy per guest. Distribute at guest orientation.

IDSC 4101: Agentic AI for Business Applications AI Innovation Showcase — Guest Guide

Thank you for joining us. This is the capstone event for a 7-week undergraduate course on agentic AI for business. Students have spent the semester understanding generative and agentic AI, building working agents using no-code tools, and developing AI product concepts grounded in real business problems. Today you'll see their work firsthand.

Format: You are free to move between team stations at your own pace. Each team has a working demo running. Aim to visit 4–5 teams during the session. Spend 7–10 minutes at each station.

What each team will show you: - A working AI-assisted workflow or agent that addresses a specific business problem - A brief explanation of what the AI is doing - Their reasoning about at least one risk in their solution and how they designed for it

How to engage: You don't need to evaluate formally — just engage genuinely. The most useful thing you can do is ask real questions, the way you would if someone pitched this to you in a professional context. The students learn more from a skeptical but respectful conversation than from enthusiastic but surface-level praise.

Four prompt questions (use any or all — these are starting points, not a script):

1. What problem does this solve, and who benefits most? *(Listen for: specificity about the user. "Small businesses" is vague. "A restaurant owner managing multiple delivery platforms" is specific. Follow up: "Have you talked to anyone with this problem?")*

2. Walk me through what the AI is actually doing in your demo. *(Listen for: behavioral description, not abstract claims. "It analyzes data" is not an answer. "It reads the PDF, extracts the line items, and flags discrepancies" is. Follow up: "What happens when the AI gets it wrong?")*

3. What could go wrong with this in a real business, and how would you handle it? *(Listen for: a named failure mode and a specific design response — not a general statement about being careful. This is worth 15% of their grade. Follow up: "Who is responsible if it does go wrong?")*

4. If you had three more weeks, what would you build next? *(Listen for: strategic thinking beyond the demo. The best answers reveal whether they understand the limitations of their current build and have a vision for what a production-ready version would require.)*

What to avoid: - Asking technical questions that require coding knowledge to answer (these students are not engineers) - Comparing their work unfavorably to commercial products (they built this in 75 minutes with no engineering support) - Grading or scoring — you're here as a thoughtful practitioner, not a judge

Grading note: Instructors use a separate rubric. Your role is to provide the professional conversation context, not to assign scores. That said: if a team's work genuinely impresses you or a specific student handles a hard question particularly well, please tell the instructor after the session — that kind of observation is valuable and not always visible from the grading rubric.

Thank you for your time and perspective. Students will remember this conversation.

SECTION 5: GRADING RUBRIC (INSTRUCTOR USE)

Complete during or immediately after the showcase while observations are fresh.

Capstone Grading Rubric — 100 points total

Criterion	Points	What to look for
Problem Clarity	20	Is the business problem specific and meaningful? Is the affected user clearly identified? Does the team articulate what the problem costs (in time, money, or quality)?
Solution Design	25	Is the AI workflow logical and well-structured? Does the tool choice fit the problem? Is the design original rather than a direct replication of a course example? Is there evidence of genuine design thinking (goal specification, tool selection, guardrails)?
Working Demo	25	Does the demo function live? Does it clearly show the AI performing a reasoning or generation step? Is the output useful and coherent? Fallback credit (15/25): recorded demo that clearly shows the system working, even if not live.
Responsible AI Awareness	15	Does the team identify at least one specific risk (not a general category)? Do they describe a concrete design choice that addresses it — not just "we'd add oversight"?
Communication and Q&A	15	Can the team explain their work in plain language to a non-technical guest? Do they handle follow-up questions confidently and honestly? Do multiple team members participate?
Total	**100**	

Grading notes: - Grade the team, not the most articulate spokesperson. If one student carries the whole station and others can't answer basic questions, the Communication score should reflect that. - A demo that crashes but is quickly recovered with a clear explanation of what happened can still score well — the recovery demonstrates understanding. - Responsible AI Awareness is binary in one sense: if the team has no answer to "what could go wrong?" they cannot score above 8/15, regardless of demo quality.

SECTION 6: INSTRUCTOR FACILITATION DURING THE SHOWCASE

Your Role During the 55-Minute Showcase

You are not observing from the front of the room. You are moving through the space, listening to team pitches and guest conversations, intervening selectively, and gathering grading observations.

What to do in the first 10 minutes: Circulate to every station once. You're listening for two things: first, is the 90-second pitch working — is the AI described behaviorally or abstractly? Second, are all team members participating or is one person doing all the talking? Note both observations for grading.

Common situations and how to handle them:
A team's demo is not working: If a team's demo crashes or the connection fails, intervene immediately and offer the fallback: "Use your recorded screen capture and walk the guest through it." Coach the student to narrate the recording rather than apologize for the live demo failure. A confident walk-through of a recording is more impressive than a flustered live demo. Don't let the team spiral — redirect quickly.

A guest is asking a question the team clearly can't answer:	Do not rescue the student by answering for them. If the student handles it honestly ("I don't know, but here's how I'd think about finding out"), that's the right move. If the student starts fabricating or deflecting, you can step in after the exchange: "That's a great question about [topic] — it connects to what we covered in Week 6. [Student name], what do you remember about that?" This redirects without undermining.
A team is clearly over-performing — the demo is strong, the pitch is sharp, the guest is engaged:	Leave them alone. Your time is better spent at stations that need support. Make a note for the grading rubric.

A team is clearly under-performing — the demo is weak, the pitch is abstract, the guest is disengaged:	After the guest moves on, spend 2 minutes with the team. Ask: “What’s the clearest way to describe what the AI is doing?” Help them find the behavioral description. Give them one specific thing to change in the next guest conversation. Don’t debrief at length — the next guest is coming.
A guest is spending much longer than the rotation time at one station:	This is almost always a good sign — strong engagement. Let it run. The rotation schedule is a guide, not a rule. Guests who are genuinely interested in a team’s work should have time to pursue that conversation.

Two teams are struggling simultaneously: Triage. Go to the team whose situation is recoverable in 2 minutes first. The other will manage until you get there.
Observing for Grading
During the showcase, you are your own grading instrument. Use the rubric from Section 5 as a mental checklist, not a formal scoring sheet. You'll complete the written rubric after the session.

What to note in real time: - Teams where the responsible AI moment is specific and clearly connected to a design choice (high Responsible AI score) - Teams where every member participates and fields a question independently (high Communication score) - Demos that fail but are recovered with confidence (full Working Demo credit, plus evidence of real understanding) - Teams where the problem statement evolves and sharpens across rounds — you can hear the pitch get better in real time (this is evidence of understanding, not memorization)

What to document after the showcase: Complete rubric scores for each team within 24 hours while observations are fresh. Add one narrative comment per team — 2–3 sentences on what distinguished their work, to be shared in the post-session feedback.

SECTION 7: POST-SHOWCASE DEBRIEF (20 minutes, students only)

After guests depart, the class comes together for a closing debrief. This is the final formal class meeting. It should feel like a close, not a wrap-up.

Structure

Opening (2 minutes): Thank the class. Name one thing you observed that surprised you — something a team did that you didn't expect, a question a guest asked that pushed a team in a good direction, or a moment where a student handled a hard question exceptionally well. Be specific. Students remember being seen.

Team observations (10 minutes): Go around the room — one observation per team, from the instructor. Not a grade preview. An honest observation about what distinguished their work: - "Your responsible AI moment was the most specific in the class — you named the exact failure scenario and the exact design response. That's what it looks like in practice." - "Your demo had a rough moment in the first round, and by the third round you'd adjusted the explanation to preempt the question that broke it. That's how products improve." - "Your problem statement got sharper every round. The first time I heard it, it was vague. By the fourth time, it was specific enough that I would have understood it without knowing the course."

Class reflection (5 minutes): Three questions, brief answers — go around once: 1. "What was the best question a guest asked you?" 2. "What would you change about your demo if you had one more week?" 3. "What did you learn in this course that you didn't expect to learn?"

Close (3 minutes): The formal close of the course. Keep it short. End with the same frame you started the session with in Session 1: the person in the room who asks the right questions about AI. Name who that person is now — it's them. They spent seven weeks earning that. Let them leave with that.

SECTION 8: WHAT STUDENTS SUBMIT AND WHEN

Capstone deliverables (submitted before Session 2): - Working demo link (functional URL or file link demonstrating the agent running) - 3-slide pitch deck (Problem / Solution / Responsible AI — submitted as PDF or slides link)

Reflection Post 4 (individual, due before Week 7 Session 1): Already submitted. No action needed in Session 2.

No additional submission after the showcase. The showcase is the capstone event. Grading is based on the live observation rubric (Section 5).

SECTION 9: COMMON SHOWCASE SCENARIOS AND RESPONSES

Scenario: A team's agent has drifted significantly from their original Week 4 blueprint. This is fine and expected — the blueprint was designed before the build, and builds evolve. What matters is whether the team can explain what changed and why. If a guest asks about the original design versus the final build, the team should be able to say: "We designed it this way, but when we built it we discovered [X], so we changed [Y]." That's good product development thinking.

Scenario: A guest pushes hard on a risk the team hasn't thought about. Don't intervene. This is one of the most valuable interactions in the showcase. A student who says "I hadn't thought about that — that's a really important point" is demonstrating intellectual honesty, which is a form of responsible AI thinking. A student who deflects or minimizes is missing the moment. After the guest moves on, briefly acknowledge it: "That was a good catch. How would you address it if you were rebuilding?"

Scenario: Two teams built essentially the same agent. This happens, and it doesn't diminish either project. If guests notice and ask, the team should be able to describe what's distinctive about their design choices. "We both built customer service agents, but our guardrail design is different because our use case had a different escalation risk" is a strong response. Coach teams toward differentiation at the design level, not the surface level.

Scenario: A guest becomes over-critical or dismissive of a student's work. Rare, but possible. If a guest is engaging in a way that feels discouraging rather than constructively critical, intervene gently: "This is a great observation — [student name], what do you think about that constraint in the context of your problem?" This shifts the dynamic without confronting the guest directly.

Scenario: A student becomes visibly anxious or shuts down. Make brief eye contact and give a small nod or encouraging gesture from across the room. If the student is genuinely stuck and the guest is waiting, approach the station: "Let me add some context here — [student name] can correct me if I get anything wrong." Give a brief framing, then hand it back. Don't take over the conversation; give the student a re-entry point.

SECTION 10: CAPSTONE FINAL CHECKLIST FOR INSTRUCTOR

Before the session: ☐ Room arranged with stations — one per team, power access, table space ☐ Guest list confirmed, judge packets printed (one per guest) ☐ Rotation schedule posted on screen (if using structured rotation) ☐ Timer visible (projector or screen showing current round time) ☐ LMS confirms all demo submissions received — follow up with any missing teams

During the session: ☐ Guest orientation complete before students begin pitching ☐ Circulate continuously — at least one pass per team every 15 minutes ☐ Note grading observations in real time (phone notes are fine) ☐ Manage timing signals for guest rotation

After the session: ☐ Thank guests personally before they leave ☐ Complete rubric scores for all teams within 24 hours ☐ Post one narrative comment per team to LMS (2–3 sentences) ☐ Return Reflection Post 4 grades within one week

---

SECTION 11: CLOSING NOTE TO INSTRUCTOR

The AI Innovation Showcase is the hardest session of the course to run well — and the most rewarding when it works. The logistics are more complex than a lecture. The variability is higher. You have less control over what happens.

That's the point.

The students have spent seven weeks in a controlled learning environment where the uncertainty was managed and the failure modes were designed. Today they're in a setting where the guests ask unexpected questions, the demos behave unpredictably, and the learning is real-time and unscripted. That's what working with AI in business actually looks like.

Your job today is not to make it perfect. It's to make it real — to hold the space for genuine professional engagement between students who built something and people who know the domain. The students who struggle and recover will learn more than the ones who sail through. The guests who ask the hardest questions are doing the most for the learning outcomes.

Trust the format. Trust the students. They built something worth showing.